

Amendment No. 1 to SB1159

Briggs
Signature of Sponsor

AMEND Senate Bill No. 1159

House Bill No. 674*

by deleting all language after the enacting clause and substituting:

SECTION 1.

(a) The Tennessee Department of Correction shall study:

(1) The impact of fostering connections between incarcerated persons and their families to reduce recidivism, including whether regular visitation from family members to an incarcerated person lowers the likelihood of that person reoffending;

(2) The costs to families of incarcerated persons to visit family members and loved ones who are incarcerated at distant facilities; and

(3) The parameters of programs in other states that authorize a qualified incarcerated person to be transferred to a facility closer to the person's family, including the programs' eligibility requirements, costs to the respective states or local governments, reduction in travel costs to family members of incarcerated persons, and success in reducing reincarceration and other positive outcomes.

(b) The Department may request information and input from other appropriate state and local governmental entities, as necessary. Each such entity shall comply with the Department's request. The study must be conducted from the Department's existing resources.

(c) By no later than January 31, 2027, the Department shall report its findings to each member of the general assembly and shall provide a copy of the report to the legislative librarian. The report may be delivered electronically.

SECTION 2. This act takes effect upon becoming a law, the public welfare requiring it.